

Path Independence

SOLNS

Problem 1

$$a) \vec{F} = 2x\vec{i} + 3y\vec{j} + 4z\vec{k}$$

$$\Rightarrow \text{curl } \vec{F} = \vec{0}$$

conservative

$$b) \vec{F} = [y, x+z, -y]$$

$$\Rightarrow \text{curl } \vec{F} = [-2, 0, 0] \neq \vec{0}$$

$$c) \vec{F} = -y\vec{i} + x\vec{j}$$

$$\Rightarrow \text{curl } \vec{F} = [0, 0, 2] \neq \vec{0}$$

$$d) \vec{F} = [e^{y+2z}, xe^{y+2z}, 2xe^{y+2z}]$$

$$\Rightarrow \text{curl } \vec{F} = [0, 0, 0] = \vec{0}$$

conservative

Problem 2

$$a) [2x, 3y, 4z] = [f_x, f_y, f_z]$$

$$f_x = 2x \Rightarrow f = x^2 + g(y, z)$$

$$3y = f_y = g_y \Rightarrow g = \frac{3}{2}y^2 + h(z)$$

$$f = x^2 + \frac{3}{2}y^2 + h(z)$$

$$4z = f_z = h_z \Rightarrow h = 2z^2 + C$$

$$\boxed{f = x^2 + \frac{3}{2}y^2 + 2z^2}$$

$$b) [e^{y+2z}, xe^{y+2z}, 2xe^{y+2z}] = [f_x, f_y, f_z]$$

$$f_x = e^{y+2z} \Rightarrow f = xe^{y+2z} + g(y, z)$$

$$xe^{y+2z} = f_y = xe^{y+2z} + g_y \Rightarrow g_y = 0 \Rightarrow g = h(z)$$

$$f = xe^{y+2z} + h(z)$$

$$2xe^{y+2z} = f_z = 2xe^{y+2z} + h_z \Rightarrow h_z = 0 \Rightarrow h = C$$

$$\boxed{f = xe^{y+2z}}$$